SERTRALINE

Safe after MI

Preferred in breastfeeding

CHEMICAL NAME (1S,4S)-4-(3,4-dichlorophenyl)-N-methyl-1,2,3,4-tetrahydronaphthalen-1-amine (hydrochloride)

CLASS Selective serotonin reuptake inhibitor (SSRI)

TRADE NAMES Zoloft · Lustral · Serlift · Serenata

THERAPEUTIC USES / INDICATIONS

- Major depression (incl. after MI/heart disease).
- Anxiety disorders: GAD, panic, social anxiety, PTSD.
- OCD (adults and children ≥6 yr).
- Premenstrual dysphoric disorder.

ADMINISTRATION

- **PO** once daily (morning or evening), with or without food.

DOSAGES

- **Depression/anxiety:** 50 mg once daily (25 mg start for panic/PTSD), increase by 50 mg weekly; max 200 mg.
- **OCD (children 6–12 yr):** 25 mg daily; 13–17 yr 50 mg daily.

PHARMACOKINETICS

- **Onset:** 2–4 weeks. **Peak:** 4–8 h.
- Metabolised in liver (multiple CYPs) to weakly active desmethylsertraline.
- **t½:** 26 h.

PHARMACODYNAMICS

- Selective **5-HT reuptake** inhibition; weak dopamine reuptake inhibition.

SIDE & ADVERSE EFFECTS

SIDE EFFECTS (COMMON)

- Nausea, diarrhoea, dyspepsia.
- Insomnia or somnolence, dizziness.
- Sexual dysfunction, sweating, tremor.

ADVERSE EFFECTS (SERIOUS)

- Suicidality (young people).
- Serotonin syndrome; hyponatraemia.
- Bleeding risk; mania.

CONTRAINDICATIONS & CAUTIONS

- MAOIs; pimozide.
- **Caution:** epilepsy, bleeding, liver disease.

KEY INTERACTIONS

- **MAOIs, tramadol, triptans, linezolid:** serotonin syndrome.
- **NSAIDs, anticoagulants:** bleeding.
- **Pimozide:** QT — contraindicated.

NURSING MANAGEMENT

- Monitor mood, suicide risk, side effects.
- Na^+ in elderly.
- Encourage adherence through early side effects.

PATIENT EDUCATION

- Effects take 2–4 weeks.
- Report suicidal thoughts or agitation.
- Do not stop suddenly — taper.
- Avoid alcohol.

KEY POINTS

- SSRI; first-line for depression and anxiety.
- Safe in cardiac disease.
- 50 mg daily, max 200 mg.
- Taper to stop.

SOURCES CHECKED **[768]** Sertraline 100 mg film-coated tablets (UK SmPC) **[769]** Sertraline, oral (US label) **[770]** Sertraline, oral (US label, AvPAK) *Full references p. 432–457*